

Kodak CX4200 Digital Camera

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The Kodak CX4200 is a 2 megapixel camera with a maximum resolution of 1632x1232. Its rounded contours fit nicely into the palm and is light enough to be carried in the pocket. The buttons are slightly tacky to feel but are well-placed. The optical viewfinder is at the extreme left, just above the lens, so you have to place your fingers carefully. It has a 2x digital zoom that lets you shoot close-up photos despite the absence of optical zoom. It has a 1.6-colour TFT LCD, but it darkens in the sunlight. The camera has a Video Out jack and a USB port and includes a video connector RCA cable along with a USB cable. It has 16 MB internal memory and can accommodate 20 to 23 pictures at maximum resolution. You can increase the capacity by using a 64 MB Compact Flash card. The camera supports a wide range of power options with an in-camera charging option through the camera dock, two AA lithium or Ni-MH batteries



or one CRV3 lithium battery. The camera comes with an optional docking stand that also serves as a charging dock. A file transfer button on the dock makes sharing files very simple. The only sore spot is that Kodak did not provide a cover for the camera.

In our tests, the CX4200 was able to capture all the details but without the flash, the picture looked dark. In the resolution test, the image came out hazy. Though the camera has good colour reproduction, the overall image quality is poor.

Overall, this camera produces sharp and colourful images when used in well lit conditions, but if you want clarity and picture depth at high resolution, then this camera is surely not for you.

SPECIFICATIONS

16 MB internal memory, MMC/SD slot, 2 megapixel resolution, 2x digital zoom, 1.6-inch TFT colour LCD screen, 220 gm weight, JPEG/EXIF v2.2 compression

Kodak CX4200		B
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶	

Price: Rs 13,900

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Iomega CD-RW 48x24x48x USB 2.0 Drive

Write on target

The Iomega is an external USB 2.0 CD-Writer. The back panel has the USB, PS/2 look-alike power connector and Audio Out jacks. The power connector is unique to this model and could pose a



problem if the cord gets damaged as you can only obtain it from Iomega. The device is USB 2.0 ready and is capable of 48x write and read speed and a 24x rewrite speed. The only bottleneck is the

rare 48x media.

The writer burned 700 MB of assorted data at 40x in just 3 minutes, 18 seconds. It took a little under 3 minutes to burn a 610 MB ISO image and 7 minutes, 27 seconds to rewrite 700 MB at 12x—pretty good for 12x and once 24x media is easily available, the results will be even better.

In its CD-ROM drive incarnation, it copied the 700 MB of data on the ATA100

Price: Rs 9,900

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drive in just 2 minutes, 57 seconds. This product is a good buy for those who need a portable writer that does justice to its price of Rs 9,900.

SPECIFICATIONS

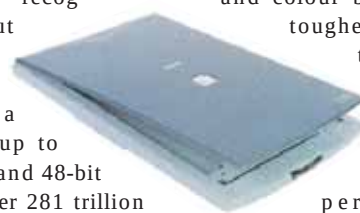
External USB 2.0 interface, 48x write and read speed, 24x rewrite speed
System Requirements: Pentium 166 MHz processor, Windows 98/Me/2000/XP, 75 MB hard drive space

Iomega CD-RW		B+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶	

Canon Canoscan LiDE 20

Standing slim

The LiDE 20 is a sleek, intuitive and user-friendly scanner. The installation is quite easy—Windows XP recognised it without any hassles. You can scan in colour at a resolution of up to 600x1200 dpi and 48-bit depth with over 281 trillion possible colours. It can also be placed vertically while scanning, thus saving on desktop space. It has a USB 2.0 interface and hence requires no external power adapters.



colour scan in a fast 47 seconds. The colour output was also quite bright and matched the original. Even contrast and colour blending, the toughest attributes to achieve, were quite remarkable. Overall, its performance, combined with the price of just Rs 4,370 makes it quite an irresistible buy.

Its Multi scan mode scans all the pictures in a single pass and each image is saved in a separate file. It even adjusts any misaligned photographs to ensure precision in your scanning. Enhanced software allows scanned images to be written directly to a CD.

As far as speed is concerned, it completed a full

SPECIFICATIONS

600x1200 dpi optical resolution, 9600x9600 dpi interpolated resolution, 8.5x11.7 inch scan area, 48-bit colour depth, USB 2.0 interface. Package includes USB cable, Scanner stand and Canon Documentation Kit with CD containing ScanGear CS (Windows/Mac) CanoScan Toolbox (Windows/Mac) ArcSoft PhotoStudio, ArcSoft PhotoBase and ScanSoft OmniPage SE

Price: Rs 4,370

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Canon Canoscan LiDE 20		B+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶	